

said to be completely 'Made in India'.

Datawind had won the first round of bidding to supply 100,000 Aakash devices. The second round of bidding to manufacture Aakash 2, the enhanced version of the world's cheapest tablet PC, should commence later in 2012. However, the government has not yet disclosed the timing of the tender or the number of tablets to be supplied.

Gentoo Linux releases 12.1 LiveDVD

Gentoo Linux has announced the availability of a new LiveDVD, which is based on the Linux 3.3 kernel and includes KDE SC 4.8.1, GNOME 3.2.1 and Xfce 4.8, as well as Fluxbox 1.3.2. The new release is said to be '100 per cent real'. It also includes the Gentoo installer—an extra feature, which according to the developers, is the “most intelligent Gentoo Install Wizard yet” that sends users to the help pages on the project's website.



Debian and CENATIC join open source initiative

The Debian project, maintainers of one of the most popular GNU/Linux distributions, and CENATIC, the Spanish government's competency centre for open source software, have joined the Open Source Initiative (OSI) under its affiliate scheme. “Now that we have the new OSI Board in place with two directors selected by the affiliates, I hope that the pace of OSI's evolution will increase and that the affiliates will play an increasing role in devising the new structures and programmes that will form the heart of the new OSI,” mentions an OSI blog post.

Open source Star Trek Tricorder released!

Dr Peter Jansen has released the designs for a series of Science Tricorders that he developed while studying at McMaster University. The Science Tricorders can sense a variety of atmospheric, electromagnetic, and spatial phenomena. The Science Tricorder Mark 1 is a relatively easy-to-build proof of concept, while Dr Jansen's Mark 2 model runs Linux and includes an ARM Atmel microcontroller squeezed into a clam-shell with dual OLED touch displays.



Schematics, board layouts and the firmware are available for free on the Tricorder project website under various open licences.

“The Tricorder Project aims to bring a diverse array of inexpensive



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